

PREMIUM GUIDE

CORNELL UNIVERSITY

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Ithaca, New York

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1. Cornell University at a Glance

#16

QS RANKING

1865

FOUNDED

25,000

STUDENTS

800+

INDIAN STUDENTS

93%

PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	Cornell University
Location	Ithaca, New York, USA
Type	Private (Est. 1865)
Acceptance Rate	7%
Student-Faculty Ratio	9:1
Graduation Rate	95%
International Students	25%
Gender Ratio	50:50 (F:M)
Website	cornell.edu
Motto	Ivy League Engineering — 800+ Indian Students

Cornell University is a private Ivy League research university in Ithaca, New York. Known for its exceptional engineering, hotel management, and computer science programs, Cornell combines Ivy League prestige with a strong STEM focus. The campus is stunning, set among gorges and waterfalls in upstate New York.

Notable Alumni

Bill Nye — The Science Guy

Ratan Tata — Former Chairman of Tata Group (honorary)

2. Why Choose Cornell?

- QS #16 — Ivy League prestige
- 800+ Indian students — tight-knit community
- Top 10 in Engineering, CS, and Hotel Management
- Beautiful campus among gorges and waterfalls
- Strong research funding and accessible faculty
- Cornell Tech campus in NYC for additional opportunities

| Academic Environment

Ivy League rigor with a practical, hands-on approach. Cornell is known as the 'easiest Ivy to get into, hardest to stay in.' Professors are world-renowned researchers who are surprisingly accessible. The engineering programs are particularly strong with excellent lab facilities.

| Student Life

Ithaca is a small, liberal college town surrounded by stunning natural beauty — gorges, waterfalls, and lakes. The pace is slower than NYC or Boston, but the community is tight-knit. The Indian community is active and supportive. Winters are cold but the campus is gorgeous year-round.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MS in Computer Science	PG	2 Years	\$30K-34K/yr	Top 5 CS with strengths in AI, systems, theory, and scientific computing.
MS in Electrical & Computer Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$30K-34K/yr	Top 10 ECE with VLSI, embedded systems, and computer architecture.
MS in Mechanical Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$30K-34K/yr	Top 8 ME with automotive, robotics, and aerospace specialisations.
MBA	PG	2 Years	\$75K-80K/yr	Johnson MBA with a strong consulting and finance focus.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	8.0+ (First Class with Distinction)
GRE	320+ (325+ recommended)
IELTS	7.0+
TOEFL	100+
Work Experience	Not required (3+ yrs for MBA)
LORs	3 LORs
SOP	Required (research focus for MS)
Resume	Required
Interview	MBA only
Application Fee	\$105

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Aug)	Dec 1 (priority)	Feb 15
Spring (Jan)	Oct 1	Nov 15

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	\$30,000-34,000/yr
Accommodation	\$9,000-18,000/yr
Food	\$5,000-7,000/yr
Transport	\$500/yr
Health Insurance	\$3,000/yr
Personal	\$3,000-5,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship		Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Cornell Fellowship	Graduate	\$10,000-20,000/yr	Merit-based for graduate students	Rolling
Tata-Cornell Scholarship		\$15,000-25,000/yr	Indian students in agriculture/nutrition programs	Dec 1

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

93% PLACEMENT RATE	\$115,000 AVG SALARY	\$200,000 HIGHEST SALARY	600+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	Cornell India Association — 200+ members
Accommodation	On-campus graduate housing + off-campus apartments
Avg Rent	\$800-1,500/month
Indian Food	Multiple Indian restaurants on the Commons, Indian grocery stores
Weather	Cold snowy winters (-10°C), mild summers (25°C). Beautiful fall foliage.
Transport	TCAT bus system (free for students) + campus walking
Healthcare	Cornell Health (on-campus)
Safety	Very safe campus. Low crime rate.

Nightlife & Social Scene

The Commons in downtown Ithaca. Collegetown bars. House parties. Ithaca is quieter than big cities but has a vibrant college-town energy.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **Cornell India Association** — Cultural
- **Cornell Cricket Club** — Sports
- **Cornell Bhangra** — Dance
- **Cornell AI** — Tech
- **Cornell Consulting Club** — Professional
- **Cornell Outdoor Education** — Outdoor

11. What Students Say

"Cornell gorges are real — I cross a waterfall on my way to class every day."

— Arjun, MS CS '24

"Ivy League engineering at its best. The research opportunities here are unmatched."

— Karan, MS ECE '25

"The dining halls are famous for a reason. And the fall foliage is breathtaking."

— Priya, MBA '24

Your Cornell Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your Cornell University application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

